Daily truck and trailer inspection checklist

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The walk-around for a crew truck pulling an equipment trailer, before you leave the yard. It takes about five minutes, and it's the checklist most likely to stop a wheel from coming off on the highway.

Good practice for every truck and trailer. Whether it's legally required depends on your rig and where you drive; see the note at the bottom.

Truck

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Tires: pressure, cuts, tread	Daily		
Wheels: lug nuts all there and tight, no cracked rims	Daily		
Lights and reflectors	Daily		
Brakes and parking brake	Daily	Set the trailer brake controller gain	
Steering, horn, wipers and washer	Daily		
Mirrors adjusted	Daily		
Fluids and DEF; look underneath for leaks	Daily		
Triangles and fire extinguisher on board	Daily		

Hitch and trailer

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Coupler latched and pinned, right ball size	Every hookup	Or gooseneck / 5th-wheel jaws locked	
Safety chains crossed and attached	Every hookup	Not hooked to the hitch ball itself	
Breakaway cable on the truck, battery charged	Every hookup	Cable to the truck, not to the chains	
Trailer plug connected, trailer lights work	Every hookup		
Jack raised	Every hookup		
Trailer tires and lug nuts	Daily		

Load

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Straps and chains tight, no frays	Every load		
Buckets, blades and booms lowered	Every load		
Ramps up and pinned, loose tools secured	Every load		
Bucket or dump trucks: boom cradled, outriggers up, PTO off	Before driving		

Paperwork (commercial vehicles)

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Registration and yearly inspection proof current	Check monthly	If your rig counts as a commercial vehicle	
Review the last inspection report if it listed problems	Before driving		

Required by code? Federal rules (FMCSA) treat a truck as a commercial motor vehicle when the truck or truck-and-trailer is rated 10,001 lb or more and it's used in interstate commerce. Most 1-ton trucks pulling an equipment trailer are over that weight. For those, the driver must be satisfied the rig is safe before driving, a written report is needed when a problem is found, and each truck and trailer needs a yearly inspection with proof on board. Equipment over 10,000 lb needs at least 4 tie-downs. Trucks used only within one state follow that state's rules: Alabama, for example, applies the federal rules to intrastate trucks of 26,001 lb or more. Requirements vary by state, so check with yours.

Daily sign-off

Week of: _____

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DATE	TRUCK / TRAILER	PROBLEMS FOUND	FIXED?	INITIALS

Free printable from fleetoptima.org/maintenance-schedules